



Great Fire of Rome

64 CE

A fire broke out in a shop near Rome's Circus Maximus, a huge chariot-racing stadium. Fanned by strong winds, the blaze spread quickly and destroyed nearly two-thirds of the city within nine days.

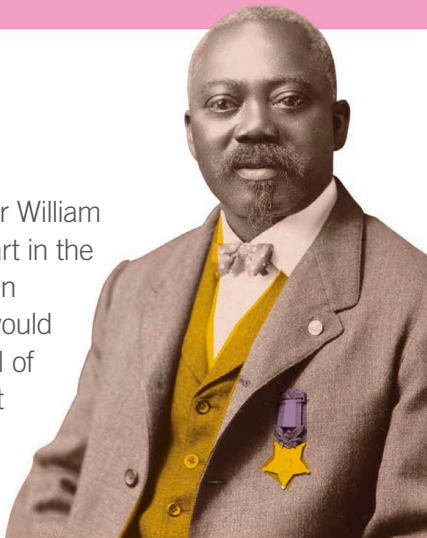
Born this day

1918 Nelson Mandela, South African freedom fighter and political leader. A member of the African National Congress, he fought against racial segregation. He served as the country's first Black president from 1994 to 1999.

1863

Civil War hero

Black American soldier William Harvey Carney took part in the Battle of Fort Wagner in the US Civil War. He would later receive the Medal of Honor, the USA's most prestigious military award, for his bravery.



July
18

Also on this day

1892 Ukrainian-French microbiologist Waldemar Haffkine injected himself with the first effective human cholera vaccine, which he had developed at the Pasteur Institute in Paris, France.

2005 Brazilian windsurfers Flavio Jardim and Diogo Guerreiro completed their 8,120 km (5,045 mile) journey along the coast of Brazil, setting a world record for the longest windsurfing journey.

1976

Perfect 10

Romanian gymnast Nadia Comăneci scored the first perfect 10 in Olympic gymnastics after a flawless routine on the uneven bars at the Montreal Olympics. Unable to display a 10, the scoreboard showed "1.00" instead.

